

## **Mahila Shakti Kendra (MSK) Scheme – Detailed Government Scheme Report**

### **Scheme Name**

**Mahila Shakti Kendra (MSK) Scheme**

**Also Known As: Pradhan Mantri Mahila Shakti Kendra (PMMSK)**

**Implemented By: Ministry of Women and Child Development (MWCD), Government of India**

**Official Ministry Website:**

**Ministry of Women and Child Development**

**Government Information:**

[Press Information Bureau \(PIB\)](#)

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### **1. Introduction**

The Mahila Shakti Kendra (MSK) Scheme is a women empowerment initiative launched by the Government of India to strengthen the social, economic, and educational status of women, especially in rural areas. The scheme was approved in November 2017 and implemented by the Ministry of Women and Child Development.

The primary objective of the scheme is to empower rural women through community participation, awareness generation, skill development, capacity building, and convergence of various government welfare schemes meant for women. The scheme acts as a support system that helps women access government benefits, improve their skills, and become self-reliant.

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### **2. Background of the Scheme**

Women in rural India often face challenges such as:

- Lack of education
- Limited employment opportunities
- Low awareness of government schemes
- Poor access to healthcare
- Financial dependence
- Social discrimination
- Digital illiteracy

To address these challenges and promote women empowerment at the grassroots level, the Government introduced the Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme. The scheme provides institutional support through centers established at national, state, district, and block levels.

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### **3. Objectives of Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme**

The major objectives are:

**1. Empower Rural Women**

To improve the overall social and economic status of women.

**2. Promote Community Participation**

To involve local communities and volunteers in women empowerment activities.

**3. Increase Awareness**

To spread awareness about government welfare schemes for women.

**4. Improve Access to Services**

To help women access education, healthcare, legal aid, and social welfare benefits.

**5. Promote Skill Development**

To provide training and employment-related opportunities.

**6. Support Gender Equality**

To encourage equal participation of women in society and development activities.

**7. Strengthen Women Collectives**

To support Self Help Groups (SHGs) and women organizations.

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**4. Launch Details**

| Particulars     | Details                                 |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Scheme Name     | Mahila Shakti Kendra (MSK)              |
| Launch Year     | 2017                                    |
| Ministry        | Ministry of Women and Child Development |
| Beneficiaries   | Rural Women                             |
| Coverage        | Across India                            |
| Funding Pattern | Centrally Sponsored Scheme              |
| Main Focus      | Women Empowerment                       |
| Target Areas    | Rural and Aspirational Districts        |

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**5. Key Features of the Scheme**

**Community-Based Empowerment**

The scheme empowers women through community engagement and local participation.

## **Multi-Level Structure**

The scheme functions at:

- **National Level**
- **State Level**
- **District Level**
- **Block Level**
- **Village Level**

## **Awareness Generation**

Women are informed about:

- **Government schemes**
- **Legal rights**
- **Health services**
- **Education opportunities**
- **Employment programs**

## **Student Volunteer Participation**

College students participate as volunteers to create awareness and support women empowerment activities.

## **Convergence Model**

The scheme links women with various government welfare programs.

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## **6. Structure of Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme**

The scheme operates through different institutional levels.

### **A. National Level**

Provides:

- **Policy guidance**
- **Monitoring**
- **Technical support**
- **Knowledge management**

The national level acts as the central coordinating authority.

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### **B. State Level**

## **State Resource Centre for Women (SRCW)**

**Functions include:**

- **Technical assistance**
- **Capacity building**
- **Monitoring state implementation**
- **Supporting women-related programs**

**These centers assist state governments in implementing women empowerment initiatives.**

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## **C. District Level**

### **District Level Centre for Women (DLCW)**

**Functions include:**

- **Awareness generation**
- **Scheme facilitation**
- **Grievance support**
- **Counseling services**
- **Information dissemination**

**DLCWs act as an important bridge between women and government services. Approximately 640 districts were planned for phased coverage.**

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## **D. Block Level**

**The block-level centers focus on:**

- **Community engagement**
- **Student volunteer programs**
- **Awareness campaigns**
- **Women's training activities**

**These centers work directly with rural communities.**

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## **7. Beneficiaries of the Scheme**

**The scheme mainly targets:**

### **Primary Beneficiaries**

- **Rural women**

- Women from economically weaker sections
- Women in aspirational districts
- Self Help Group members
- Young women
- Adolescent girls

#### **Secondary Beneficiaries**

- Women collectives
  - Local communities
  - Village organizations
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### **8. Areas of Support Under the Scheme**

The Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme provides support in several areas.

#### **Education**

Women receive awareness regarding:

- Literacy programs
- Educational opportunities
- Scholarships
- Higher education support

#### **Skill Development**

Training is provided in:

- Vocational skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Self-employment activities

#### **Employment**

Women receive guidance regarding:

- Job opportunities
- Government employment schemes
- Livelihood programs

#### **Digital Literacy**

Training includes:

- Internet usage

- Online services
- Digital payments
- E-governance services

#### **Health and Nutrition**

Awareness is created regarding:

- Maternal health
- Child health
- Nutrition
- Healthcare services

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### **9. Role of Student Volunteers**

One unique feature of the scheme is the involvement of college student volunteers.

#### **Responsibilities**

Student volunteers help in:

- Awareness campaigns
- Community mobilization
- Information dissemination
- Women empowerment activities
- Government scheme promotion

#### **Benefits**

- Promotes social responsibility
- Strengthens community participation
- Improves outreach in rural areas

The initiative was particularly focused on aspirational districts.

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### **10. Funding Pattern**

The scheme follows a shared funding model.

| Area                 | Funding Ratio          |
|----------------------|------------------------|
| General States       | 60:40 (Centre : State) |
| North Eastern States | 90:10                  |

| Area                    | Funding Ratio        |
|-------------------------|----------------------|
| Special Category States | 90:10                |
| Union Territories       | 100% Central Funding |

This funding structure helps states implement the scheme effectively.

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## 11. Services Provided Through Mahila Shakti Kendras

Women can receive assistance related to:

1. Government welfare schemes
  2. Skill development programs
  3. Employment opportunities
  4. Digital literacy
  5. Legal awareness
  6. Health services
  7. Nutrition programs
  8. Financial literacy
  9. Self Help Group formation
  10. Capacity building programs
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## 12. Role in Women Empowerment

The scheme contributes to women empowerment by:

### Economic Empowerment

- Skill development
- Employment opportunities
- Entrepreneurship support

### Social Empowerment

- Awareness generation
- Community participation
- Leadership development

### Educational Empowerment

- Literacy promotion

- Educational guidance

#### **Political Empowerment**

- Participation in local governance
  - Gram Sabha engagement
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### **13. Advantages of the Scheme**

#### **For Women**

- Improved awareness
- Better access to government benefits
- Increased confidence
- Skill enhancement
- Employment support

#### **For Society**

- Gender equality promotion
- Community development
- Increased women's participation
- Social inclusion

#### **For Government**

- Better implementation of welfare schemes
  - Improved outreach
  - Enhanced grassroots participation
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### **14. Challenges in Implementation**

**Some challenges faced during implementation include:**

#### **Volunteer Availability Issues**

**In certain districts, colleges and faculty support were limited.**

#### **Rural Awareness Gap**

**Many women were unaware of available services.**

#### **Infrastructure Constraints**

**Some areas lacked adequate support facilities.**

#### **Coordination Challenges**



Implementation required coordination across multiple departments.

The Government reported challenges in engaging student volunteers in some aspirational districts.

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## 15. Monitoring and Evaluation

The scheme included:

- National Task Force
- State Task Force
- District Monitoring Mechanisms
- Video Conferences
- Field Visits
- Progress Reviews

Regular monitoring ensured effective implementation and accountability.

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## 16. Integration with Other Schemes

The Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme supported and coordinated with:

- Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP)
- Women Skill Development Programs
- Self Help Group Initiatives
- Digital Literacy Programs
- Health and Nutrition Schemes

The scheme functioned as a convergence platform connecting women to multiple welfare initiatives.

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## 17. Discontinuation and Mission Shakti Integration

A significant policy update occurred in 2022.

The Government discontinued the standalone Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme from 1 April 2022. Based on evaluations and consultations, many of its women empowerment components were incorporated into the broader Mission Shakti umbrella program.

Mission Shakti includes:

- Sambal
- Samarthya

These components continue supporting women's safety, protection, and empowerment through an integrated approach.

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### 18. Impact of the Scheme

The Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme contributed to:

- Increased awareness among rural women
- Better access to government welfare schemes
- Improved participation in community activities
- Enhanced skill development opportunities
- Strengthening of women collectives
- Support for women-centric development programs

The scheme played an important role in expanding grassroots-level women empowerment initiatives across India.

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### 19. Conclusion

The Mahila Shakti Kendra Scheme was an important women empowerment initiative launched by the Government of India to strengthen the social, economic, and educational status of rural women. Through community participation, awareness generation, skill development, and convergence of welfare schemes, the program helped women access opportunities and government services more effectively. Although the standalone scheme was discontinued in 2022, its objectives and major components continue under Mission Shakti, ensuring continued support for women's empowerment, safety, and development across the country.

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### Quick Summary

| Particular                       | Details                                 |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Scheme Name                      | Mahila Shakti Kendra (MSK)              |
| Launch Year                      | 2017                                    |
| Ministry                         | Ministry of Women and Child Development |
| Target Beneficiaries Rural Women |                                         |
| Main Objective                   | Women Empowerment                       |
| Funding Pattern                  | 60:40 Centre-State                      |
| NE States Ratio                  | 90:10                                   |

| <b>Particular</b>     | <b>Details</b>                                        |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>UT Funding</b>     | <b>100% Central</b>                                   |
| <b>Key Components</b> | <b>SRCW, DLCW, Student Volunteers</b>                 |
| <b>Focus Areas</b>    | <b>Skill Development, Awareness, Digital Literacy</b> |
| <b>Present Status</b> | <b>Integrated into Mission Shakti (2022)</b>          |